

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 9

Multiple Affixes in One Word



Today I am learning to identify and explain multiple affixes in one word.

1 Learn the Meaning

Some complex words contain more than one affix. A prefix can come before the base or root, while one or more suffixes can come after it. Breaking a word into meaningful parts helps you explain both its spelling and its meaning.

unhelpful

un- + help + -ful

reusable

re- + use + -able

disagreement

dis- + agree + -ment

internationally

inter- + nation + -al + -ly

2 Build the Word

Add the prefix and suffix shown to the base or related word. Build the complex word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / related	Add affixes	New word	Meaning clue
predict	un- + -able		
use	re- + -able		
agree	dis- + -ment		
nation	inter- + -al		
respect	dis- + -ful		

3 Read and Notice

During a regional sustainability project, students compared several interconnected systems. They studied how reusable materials could reduce waste and how unpredictable weather could affect water supplies. Each group had to reconsider its original plan when new evidence appeared, and clear communication was essential because even a small miscommunication could lead to duplicated work.

One team investigated an international recycling program that involved schools in several countries. Their report explained how multinational organisations can coordinate large projects, but it also warned that unclear instructions can be counterproductive. The students noticed that many of these longer words contained more than one meaningful affix.

They analysed words such as reusable, unpredictable, interconnected and international. In each case, identifying the base or root first made the extra parts easier to see. They then examined internationally and unreasonably, noticing that a word can contain a prefix and more than one suffix.

By the end of the task, the class understood that complex words are not random strings of letters. Breaking them into prefixes, bases or roots, and suffixes gave useful clues to meaning, spelling and relationships between words in the same family.



Highlight words with two or more affixes. Underline the base or root, then mark the prefix and suffixes you can identify.

4 Word Detective

Choose one complex word from the passage and investigate how its affixes contribute to its structure and meaning.

a Write a word with two or more affixes from the passage.

b What base or root can you identify?

c Which prefix and suffixes can you identify?

d How does each affix contribute to the whole-word meaning?

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by how many affixes they contain.

reusable

unhelpful

disagreement

previewing

internationally

unreasonably

disrespectfully

multiculturalism

Two affixes

Three affixes

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

a The word internationally can be analysed as

b Use a word with at least two affixes in a sentence, then show its parts.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Identifies two or more affixes in a complex word
- ☐ Finds the base or root within a derived word
- ☐ Explains how each affix contributes to meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses complex derived words in context



Capture idea:

Find a word with two or more affixes in an academic text. Record the word, divide it into meaningful parts, and explain how the affixes